

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 736 February 2011, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Hard at work on Robert Hawes' Tasman Saddle Trip

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 7 February 2011

Barbeque at Fergs

We'll be putting on a sizzling banquet for those who are still in town. Scott is organizing the food so if you want to help drop him a line at st@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



new
endurance
category for 2011



nzac
national
bouldering
series
2011

www.nbs.org.nz

WAITOMO 5 FEBRUARY BARING HEAD 26 FEBRUARY
JARDINES 5 MARCH CASTLE HILL 12 MARCH

nzpc/011

NETOLINE +





TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Tasman Saddle Trip Saturday 20/11/2010 to Sunday 28/11/2010

Members on the trip: Robert Hawes (Leader), Alex Berryman, Andrew McKinlay, Liam Jackson (Australian Section), Lisa Wynne (Australian Section)



Thanks to outstanding weather, a most enjoyable and extremely successful trip was had. It was also nice that we had members on the trip from another section of the Alpine club. The weather was so kind and nice that all "rest" days were cancelled on this trip!!!! Following is the days and climbs, followed by details on each climb

Day

Saturday 20th
Sunday 21st

Monday 22nd
Tuesday 23rd
Wednesday 24th
Thursday 25th
Friday 26th

Saturday 27th

Sunday 28th

Climb

Travel to Mt Cook, stayed at Unwin Lodge due to weather
Flight in and Climbed **Mt Aylmer (2699m) & Hochstetter Dome (2827m)**

Climbed **Mt Green (2837m) & Mt Walter (2905m)**

Climbed **Mt Elie de Beaumont (3109m) via Anna Glacier**

Climbed **Mt Abel (2688m) & Peak 9144 (2669m)**

Climbed **Mt Annan (2934m)**

Attempted to Climb **Mt Brodrick (2669m)** and then flew out (and had few beers)

Climbed **Sebastopol Bluffs (Rock) by Unwin Hut** (and had a few beers)

Departed Unwin Lodge for home/further travels for our Australian Friends (and had a few beers)

Mt Aylmer & Hochstetter

When we looked out the door at 6.15am of Unwin Lodge we thought we would be going nowhere, low cloud, mist & rain, however a call at 7.30am told us we would as things were clearing quickly above the mist. A quick breakfast saw ready to go at 8.30am and dropped into Tasman Saddle Hut soon after.

We unpacked (well really just tossed things in the hut), out with the ropes crampons & axes and off to make the most of the day by 10am.

We solo climbed the steep but short south face to the summit of Aylmer. A couple of guides were in front of us showing their clients the finer art of pitching. We enjoyed summit number 1 in bright sun shine (that was to stay with us all week) and descended to the Col between Aylmer & Hochstetter. We continued up and over Hochstetter and enjoyed some lunch in a sheltered spot before returning to the hut having surveyed the area, getting our bearings but also noting that the Anna Glacier to Mt Elie de Beaumont had two crevasses (one major) that would challenge us later in the week when Elie was the target!!!

It was straight forward climbing, low risk and no need for a rope apart from moving across the glacier to & from the climb.

A very suitable warm up to get everyone "up and running" on their crampons.



To read more you can find the full article on the NZAC website at:

<http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?p=3975#more-3975>



Barrier Knob and down Giffords Crack

A small yet perfectly formed group of Richard Davies, Jo Hoare (Canty-Westland) and Adrian Monks (OSONZAC) found the time between bad wx and other commitments to nip over Barrier Knob and down Giffords Crack.

The rain started once we were in Gills biv and let up a little bit in the morning, but the overall theme of the second day was "wet." Everything was pumping down Moraine Creek. Nice wee trip all the same.



Above Adelaide Saddle

Whanganui Bay Climbing Festival

The inaugural Whanganui Bay Climbing Festival was held on the weekend of 29-31 January 2011. The event was a huge success with climbers from all over the North Island enjoying the hospitality of the Ngati Te Maunga whanau.

Special thanks go to Tom Hepi, Chairperson of Whanganui Bay Trustees, Tania Hamil who ran registrations on Saturday and organized the hangi table, Aunty Matty who ran a weaving workshop for climbers up at marae, and Tauhopa Hepi who gave the powhiri.

James Wright, Matt, and Craig did a great job running a bolting course, and James has been busy over summer cutting tracks, clearing gorse, and cleaning routes. Brook, Frank, and Conrad from Hangdog in Lower Hutt also contributed to the weekend by running workshops on belaying and climbing technique, and Hangdog donated \$1000 of gear for a raffle to raise money for the marae.

And of course a huge "thank you" to Marlon Hepi for proposing the festival and organizing the whole thing. The weekend was brilliant, and we can't wait for 2012!





UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. As we organise the Summer Trip Schedule we seek your input and engagement:

- What trips do you want to see on the schedule?
- Which trips are you willing to organise/lead?

We are looking for outings in our traditional activities, i.e. mountaineering and rock climbing, but we also recognise that our club consists of people with a large spectrum of outdoors activities. So if you are interested in organising a trip for tramping, mountain biking, trail running or similar activities we welcome your initiative. Note that trip members are required to be adequately trained and self-sufficient, so if you offer a trip it means, in most cases, organising the logistics rather than guiding folks through the terrain. So don't be shy!

In order to present a variety of attractive outings we rely on the community of members to become involved and we invite you to step forward with your suggestions and/or by volunteering as a trip organiser. Please send all input to Hinrich Schaefer (h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz). We look forward to a fun, challenging, and enticing trip schedule for the upcoming summer.



Broken River, Arthur's Pass

Date: 2 – 9 January 2011

This year's Climbing Camp will be in the Broken River Ski Area from Sunday 2nd January to Sunday 9th January 2011. It will be hosted by the Caterbury/Westland Section and is a fantastic opportunity for climbers and their families to gather in the mountains for climbing, tramping and generally have fun. There is some fantastic climbing in the area: Rolleston, Murchison for Alpine climbers, Castle Hill and Quantun field for rock climbers. Plus there are lots of tramping opportunities too. See the NZAC website for details (<http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377>). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email him at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for carpooling arrangements.



CLASSIFIEDS



Asolo Alpinist GTX boots

Size: 43.3 (European) / 9.5 (US)

Colour: silver and black

Material: Exterior leather, rubber, plastic. Interior Goretex. Sole Vibram. Full steel shank

Worn just once. I subsequently buggered one knee then the other and have not done anything for the last two years. I paid \$400 for these and would be happy to get \$100 for them. Anything you can get above that can go to the club.

Maurice Ward

15 Tuawera Tce

Christchurch 8081

Ph: 03 326 4346 / 021 406 139



Boreal semi-rigid sole climbing boots

Worn about 3 times. Boreal semi-rigid sole. Size 10 1/2 (45). \$50.00

Phone Peter on 03 355 8333



NOTICES



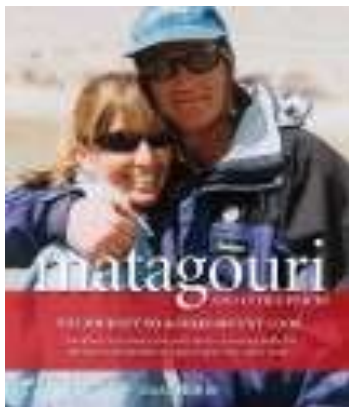
6-month membership extension winner

The December winner of our free 6-month membership extension is Canterbury / Westland Section member Derek Thatcher, and January's winner is Warren Smith also of CW Section. Congratulations to you both, we value your continued support of our Club.

Members are reminded that this is an ongoing prize offer and the February renewals are coming up. To be in with a chance to win this prize, please get your renewals paid within the first two weeks of January [Ed: and, apparently, be a member of the Canterbury / Westland Section!]



Matagouri and other pricks



We have a list minute addition to our stock of 8 copies of Mary Hobbs' new book – Matagouri and other pricks – a journey to Aoraki-Mount Cook

Member price \$45 + \$4 p&p within NZ (to post to Australia total is NZ\$64.20, for other countries please enquire)

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/matagouri-and-other-pricks>



Pakistan flood relief

The New Zealand Alpine Club received an appeal for assistance from the Alpine Club of Pakistan (via UIAA) and in response we have set up this link to receive donations towards flood affected areas in Pakistan. The Pakistan Alpine Club's President, Nazir Sabir, is calling on the assistance of all mountaineering clubs across the globe to help with the unprecedented relief efforts.

"In Gilgit and Baltistan hundreds have lost their lives, bridges have been damaged, and the KKH remains closed for traffic. There is an acute shortage of food, medicine, fuel and everything else."

We are now calling on NZAC members to support this cause by making donations towards disaster relief, which the NZAC will pass on to major aid agencies working in Pakistan and the Alpine Club of Pakistan.

Many NZAC members have climbed in Pakistan and become friends with the guides, porters and drivers who looked after them. Your valuable contribution will go a long way towards helping flood victims in this time of need.

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/pakistan-flood-appeal>



Help wanted to rid noxious Spanish...

Erica lusitanica (Spanish Heath) has established itself in the Tauherenikau valley in the Tararuas. An active group of volunteers have been laying waste to this unwanted invader but have been restricted to the valley floor. The trouble is that a colony has established itself on a slip face. These volunteers are looking for some help. They would like somebody who can abseil down the slip armed with a pair of loppers and dispatch the curse. If you can help, contact John Rhodes at rhodesja@xtra.co.nz, or phone 06 304 9095.



Rock wren research

Volunteer field assistants wanted for rock wren (*Xenicus gilviventris*) research.

Keen, fit and experienced outdoors people are required from now through until April 2011 to assist with rock wren field work throughout the South Island from Kahurangi to Fiordland. Food and accommodation will be provided. No previous bird experience required, though mist netting experience would be good. Must be able to move confidently through boulderfields and sub-alpine terrain in (sometimes rapid) pursuit of rock wren.

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/system/files/Rock%20wren%20sightings%20poster.pdf>

If able to help, please email: kerry-anne.weston@otago.ac.nz





Tukino Lodge

The Alpine Club have been working with the Tukino Alpine Sports Club to secure member privileges to their lodge at Tukino Skifield on the eastern side of Mt Ruapehu. A number of Alpine Club supporters have each contributed \$2,000 each to acquire these privileges. We have almost got our full complement of financial supporters, but we are still a few short of our target. These financial supports also attract some personal privileges from their contribution. If you can't make this amount, smaller donations are welcome.

Tukino is a fantastic spot. There are very few areas in NZ where you can dive to within a few minutes' walk of high class ice climbs. The Ski-touring is brilliant, and there is an impressive amount of rock waiting to be climbed over the summer months, all within minutes from the lodge door. The lodge is a good base for the trek up to the clubs Whangaehu hut. Being able to drive to the lodge door makes it an ideal base for family groups. And of course there is the un-crowded ski field for the winter entertainment. Tukino definitely earns its name as "the wild side" mainly because of its untouched and uncrowded nature.

If you can't help financially we are also looking for a few people to help with the maintenance program, like plumbers, builders and experts with paint brushes or shovels. We even would like some administrators. Have a look at our website: <http://tukinoalpinesportsclub.org.nz/> By the way, the hut is available for hire over the summer months to NZAC members at \$15.00pp

If you can help contact Don French at don.f@xtra.co.nz, or on 027 445 2980 / 06 377 7117.





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A really wonderful rope. ”

- Graham Zimmerman



Half ropes

Unity 8mm x 50m STD-DRY TPT **\$205**
Unity 8mm x 50m 2X-DRY TPT **\$270**
Unity 8mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$320**
Unity 9mm x 60m 2X-DRY **\$330**

Single ropes

Equinox 10.2mm x 60m STD-DRY **\$230**
Glider 9.9mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**
Pinnacle 9.5mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**

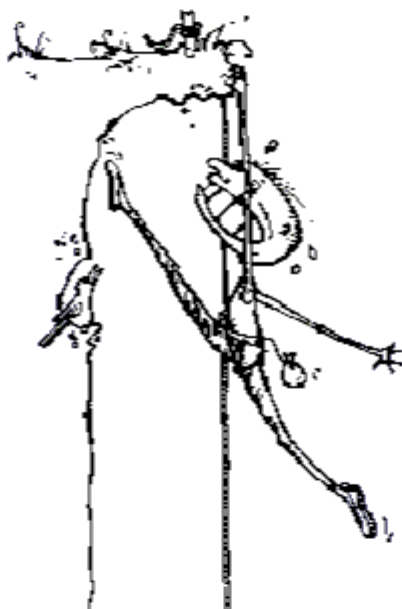
Dry treatments and TPT (reduced rope drag)
are detailed at www.iclimb.co.nz

*Maxim Ropes,
climbing brand of New England Ropes, USA*



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2010/11 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	James Wright	chairperson	027 472 5561
Vice Chair	Scott Taylor	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Matt Knarston	MK	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
	Hinrich Schaefer	HS	
	Rebecca Thomson	RT	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Convenor	Vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Vacant		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

